



Maritime Circular No.7

To:

**Ship – Owners / Managers, Company Security Officers (CSO), Registration Officers (RegOffs),
Recognised Security Organisations (RSOs), SLMARAD Technical Department**

Subject:

Ship Security Alert System (SSAS)

Date:

21st March 2025

References:

SOLAS 74 /78 Chapter XI-2 Reg 6

IMO Resolution MSC. 136 (76)

IMO Resolution MSC. 147 (77)

IMO MSC/Circ. 1072

IMO MSC/Circ. 1155

IMO MSC.1/Circ.1190

ISPS Code 2002

Purpose

To provide instructions and procedures for the programming and use of the Ship Security Alert System (SSAS).

Application

1. All Sierra Leonean vessels must report **directly** to the Company Security Officer (CSO) and this Administration in case of **SSAS ALERT** or **SSAS TEST** at the below email address:
ssas@slmarad.com
2. If the company has appointed a third-party service provider for the management of SSAS alerts and tests, they must ensure that SSAS alerts are directly reported to the CSO and the Administration.
3. The message must include the following information:
 - a. Name of vessel
 - b. IMO Number
 - c. Call Sign
 - d. Maritime Mobile Service Identity
 - e. Date and time (UTC)
 - f. GNSS position (latitude and longitude) of the ship
 - g. Course and speed
4. In case of receiving a **SSAS TEST** message, SLMARAD will confirm the SSAS TEST as requested by the Operator, and/or CSO, and/or Master of the vessel. **In this case, the word "TEST" shall be clearly indicated in any transmissions.**

5. SSAS tests must be performed under the following circumstances:
 - a. During the vessel's annual SSAS test.
 - b. During the change of Flag to Sierra Leone.
 - c. After the installation of new SSAS equipment onboard.
6. In case of SSAS ALERT, SLMARAD shall always require confirmation of the status of the ship and its crew.
7. When the Ship Security Alert System - SSAS, is found faulty, and continues to transmit repeated false alerts, the Company or the Company Security Officer (CSO) or the Master must inform immediately SLMARAD and make necessary arrangements with shore maintenance to repair the fault as soon as possible.
8. ISPS Code, Section 13 of Part A and Section 13-7 of Part B requires all vessels to carry out drills, exercises and tests at least once each calendar year with no more than 18 months between exercises. Sierra Leonean flag vessels shall follow this requirement.
9. When the Ship Security Alert System – SSAS, accidentally transmits, during testing a false alarm, the Company or the Company Security Officer (CSO) or the Master must inform immediately SLMARAD.
10. SLMARAD accepts that a safety drill, which has a security component within it, can be credited as a security drill. The interval between security drills shall not exceed three (3) months. Sierra Leone recommends all registered vessels to keep records of all the drills for a period of time defined in the Ship Security Plan, or as per the procedures of the Company. If such a period is not defined in neither of the mentioned documents, then the records must be kept for a period of five (5) years.
11. These records must be in the working language or languages of the ship. If the language or languages used are not English, French or Spanish, a translation into one of these languages shall be included.
12. The records may be kept in an electronic format. In such a case, they shall be protected by procedures aimed at preventing their unauthorised deletion, destruction or amendment.
13. The records shall be protected from unauthorised access or disclosure and must be available for any authority that requires to review.
14. The above reporting system will enter into effect as of 21st of March 2025.

For additional information please contact SLMARAD at info@slmarad.com

Revision Status

Date	Revision	Comments - Changes
10/01/2017	0	Initial - Adopted
21/03/2025	1	Amended Paragraph 1, Added Paragraph 2 and 5